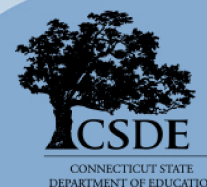


# DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



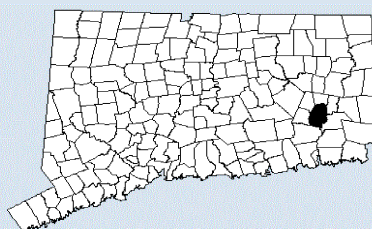
## Norwich School District

Kristen Stringfellow, Superintendent • 860-823-4200 • <http://www.norwichpublicschools.org>

### District Information

|                                     |              |
|-------------------------------------|--------------|
| Grade Range                         | PK-12        |
| Number of Schools/Programs          | 18           |
| Enrollment                          | 3,377        |
| Per Pupil Expenditures <sup>1</sup> | \$17,954     |
| Total Expenditures <sup>1</sup>     | \$98,604,938 |

<sup>1</sup> Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



### Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

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### Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

\* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

## Students

### October 1, 2020 Enrollment<sup>2</sup>

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Female                                    | 1,596 | 47.3                                | 48.4                             |
| Male                                      | 1,781 | 52.7                                | 51.5                             |
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 14    | 0.4                                 | 0.3                              |
| Asian                                     | 227   | 6.7                                 | 5.2                              |
| Black or African American                 | 610   | 18.1                                | 12.7                             |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 1,190 | 35.2                                | 27.8                             |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 12    | 0.4                                 | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 357   | 10.6                                | 4.0                              |
| White                                     | 967   | 28.6                                | 49.9                             |
| English Learners                          | 618   | 18.3                                | 8.3                              |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals  | 2,416 | 71.5                                | 42.7                             |
| Students with Disabilities <sup>3</sup>   | 676   | 20.0                                | 16.3                             |

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (\*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

<sup>3</sup> Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

### Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

|                                          | Chronic Absenteeism <sup>4</sup> |          | Suspension/Expulsion <sup>5</sup> |          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------|-----------------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Count                            | Rate (%) | Count                             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                   | *                                | *        | 26                                | 1.5      |
| Male                                     | 324                              | 19.2     | 72                                | 3.7      |
| Black or African American                | 101                              | 17.2     | 28                                | 4.2      |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | 252                              | 21.7     | 31                                | 2.4      |
| White                                    | 150                              | 16.7     | 20                                | 1.9      |
| English Learners                         | 101                              | 15.9     | 13                                | 1.9      |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | 460                              | 20.8     | 74                                | 3.0      |
| Students with Disabilities               | 162                              | 27.0     | 20                                | 2.5      |
| District                                 | 593                              | 18.4     | 98                                | 2.7      |
| State                                    |                                  | 19.0     |                                   | 1.4      |

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 257

Number of school-based arrests: 0

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

<sup>4</sup> A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

<sup>5</sup> This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Educators

#### Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)<sup>1</sup> Staff

|                                                           | FTE   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------|
| <b>General Education</b>                                  |       |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 201.9 |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 26.5  |
| <b>Special Education</b>                                  |       |
| Teachers and Instructors                                  | 51.0  |
| Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants                 | 118.7 |
| <b>Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs</b> |       |
| District Central Office                                   | 7.0   |
| School Level                                              | 14.0  |
| <b>Library/Media</b>                                      |       |
| Specialists (Certified)                                   | 4.0   |
| Support Staff                                             | 0.0   |
| Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers            | 25.4  |
| Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists       | 22.0  |
| School Nurses                                             | 10.5  |
| Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support  | 248.9 |

<sup>1</sup> In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

#### Educators by Race/Ethnicity

|                                           | Count | District<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) | State<br>Percent of Total<br>(%) |
|-------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| American Indian or Alaska Native          | 1     | 0.3                                 | 0.1                              |
| Asian                                     | 8     | 2.4                                 | 1.3                              |
| Black or African American                 | 5     | 1.5                                 | 4.1                              |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race            | 4     | 1.2                                 | 4.3                              |
| Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander | 1     | 0.3                                 | 0.1                              |
| Two or More Races                         | 1     | 0.3                                 | 0.1                              |
| White                                     | 309   | 93.9                                | 89.9                             |

#### Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

|                                                                   | District | State |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-------|
| Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time | 8.8      | 7.3   |

### Instruction and Resources

#### 11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School<sup>2</sup>

|                                          | 11th  |          | 12th  |          |
|------------------------------------------|-------|----------|-------|----------|
|                                          | Count | Rate (%) | Count | Rate (%) |
| Black or African American                | *     | *        | 6     | *        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | 0     | *        | *     | *        |
| White                                    | *     | *        | 23    | 82.1     |
| English Learners                         | 0     | *        | *     | *        |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | *     | *        | 6     | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | *     | *        | *     | *        |
| District                                 | *     | *        | 38    | 82.6     |
| State                                    |       | 75.9     |       | 85.6     |

<sup>2</sup> College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

#### Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers<sup>3</sup>

|                            | Count | Rate (%) |
|----------------------------|-------|----------|
| Autism                     | 55    | 36.7     |
| Emotional Disturbance      | 38    | 38.8     |
| Intellectual Disability    | 8     | 18.2     |
| Learning Disability        | 247   | 81.5     |
| Other Health Impairment    | 119   | 69.6     |
| Other Disabilities         | 10    | 24.4     |
| Speech/Language Impairment | 81    | 88.0     |
| District                   | 558   | 62.1     |
| State                      |       | 67.9     |

<sup>3</sup> This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability<sup>1</sup>

|                            | District |          | State    |
|----------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                            | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Autism                     | 165      | 3.1      | 2.1      |
| Emotional Disturbance      | 98       | 1.8      | 1.1      |
| Intellectual Disability    | 44       | 0.8      | 0.5      |
| Learning Disability        | 303      | 5.7      | 5.8      |
| Other Health Impairment    | 172      | 3.2      | 3.3      |
| Other Disabilities         | 69       | 1.3      | 1.2      |
| Speech/Language Impairment | 108      | 2.0      | 1.9      |
| All Disabilities           | 959      | 17.9     | 15.9     |

<sup>1</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District<sup>2</sup>

|                                   | District |          | State    |
|-----------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
|                                   | Count    | Rate (%) | Rate (%) |
| Public Schools in Other Districts | 337      | 35.1     | 8.3      |
| Private Schools or Other Settings | 102      | 10.6     | 4.8      |

<sup>2</sup> This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

### Overall Expenditures<sup>3</sup>: 2019-20

|                                                | Total (\$)   | Per Pupil     |            |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------|------------|
|                                                |              | District (\$) | State (\$) |
| Instruction                                    | \$76,402,107 | \$13,912      | \$11,205   |
| Support services - students                    | \$4,985,849  | \$1,429       | \$1,346    |
| Support services - instruction                 | \$69,138     | \$20          | \$698      |
| Support services - general administration      | \$922,723    | \$264         | \$464      |
| Support services - school based administration | \$2,459,463  | \$705         | \$1,037    |
| Central and other support services             | \$1,264,391  | \$362         | \$691      |
| Operation and maintenance of plant             | \$4,475,336  | \$1,283       | \$1,692    |
| Student transportation services                | \$7,638,692  | \$1,443       | \$1,159    |
| Food services                                  | .            | .             | \$21       |
| Enterprise operations                          | \$387,240    | \$111         | \$151      |
| Total                                          | \$98,604,938 | \$17,954      | \$17,838   |

<sup>3</sup> Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

### Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

|                                                          | District     |                      | State                |
|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                                          | Total (\$)   | Percent of Total (%) | Percent of Total (%) |
| Teacher Salaries                                         | \$5,045,656  | 15.3                 | 29.6                 |
| Instructional Aide Salaries                              | \$3,322,607  | 10.1                 | 11.1                 |
| Other Salaries                                           | \$181,231    | 0.6                  | 9.5                  |
| Employee Benefits                                        | \$1,975,941  | 6.0                  | 13.5                 |
| Purchased Services Other Than Transportation             | \$1,537,370  | 4.7                  | 5.4                  |
| Special Education Tuition                                | \$16,842,490 | 51.2                 | 22.5                 |
| Supplies                                                 | \$135,061    | 0.4                  | 0.5                  |
| Property Services                                        | \$4,623      | 0.0                  | 0.3                  |
| Purchased Services For Transportation                    | \$3,856,377  | 11.7                 | 7.2                  |
| Equipment                                                | \$21,549     | 0.1                  | 0.2                  |
| All Other Expenditures                                   | \$1,620      | 0.0                  | 0.1                  |
| Total                                                    | \$32,924,524 | 100.0                | 100.0                |
| Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education |              | 33.4                 | 25.1                 |

### Expenditures by Revenue Source<sup>4</sup>: 2019-20

|                 | Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Local           | 50.3                                               |
| State           | 43.4                                               |
| Federal         | 5.5                                                |
| Tuition & Other | 0.9                                                |

<sup>4</sup> Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Performance and Accountability

#### District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

*NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>*

#### National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient<sup>1</sup>

|                 | NAEP 2019 |         | NAEP 2013 |
|-----------------|-----------|---------|-----------|
| READING         | Grade 4   | Grade 8 | Grade 12  |
| Connecticut     | 40        | 41      | 50        |
| National Public | 34        | 32      | 36        |
| MATH            | Grade 4   | Grade 8 | Grade 12  |
| Connecticut     | 45        | 39      | 32        |
| National Public | 40        | 33      | 25        |

<sup>1</sup> NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at [https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card\\_NAEP-2019.pdf](https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf)

#### Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

*NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>*

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Cohort Graduation: Four-Year<sup>1</sup>

|                                          | 2019-20                   |          |
|------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------|
|                                          | Cohort Count <sup>2</sup> | Rate (%) |
| Black or African American                | N/A                       | N/A      |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | N/A                       | N/A      |
| English Learners                         | N/A                       | N/A      |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | N/A                       | N/A      |
| Students with Disabilities               | N/A                       | N/A      |
| District                                 | N/A                       | N/A      |
| State                                    |                           | 88.8     |

<sup>1</sup> The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

<sup>2</sup> Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

### 11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam<sup>3</sup>

|                                          | Participation <sup>4</sup> | Meeting Benchmark |          |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------------|----------|
|                                          | Rate (%)                   | Count             | Rate (%) |
| Female                                   | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| Male                                     | 30.6                       | 0                 | 0.0      |
| Black or African American                | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| Hispanic or Latino                       | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| White                                    | 33.3                       | 0                 | 0.0      |
| English Learners                         | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | *                          | 0                 | *        |
| Students with Disabilities               | 34.7                       | 0                 | 0.0      |
| District                                 | 34.0                       | 0                 | 0.0      |
| State                                    | 85.0                       |                   | 36.0     |

<sup>3</sup>College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

<sup>4</sup>Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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\* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

### College Entrance and Persistence

|                                          | Class of 2020         | Class of 2019            |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|
|                                          | Entrance <sup>3</sup> | Persistence <sup>4</sup> |
|                                          | Rate (%)              | Rate (%)                 |
| Female                                   | *                     | *                        |
| Male                                     | *                     | *                        |
| Black or African American                | *                     | *                        |
| Hispanic or Latino of any race           | *                     | *                        |
| White                                    | *                     | *                        |
| English Learners                         | *                     | *                        |
| Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals | *                     | *                        |
| Students with Disabilities               | *                     | *                        |
| District                                 | *                     | *                        |
| State                                    | 67.4                  | 84.9                     |

<sup>3</sup> College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

<sup>4</sup> College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

*NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>*

| Indicator                                             |                     | Index/Rate | Target | State Average Index/Rate |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|--------|--------------------------|
| Chronic Absenteeism                                   | All Students        | 18.4%      | <=5%   | 19.0%                    |
|                                                       | High Needs Students | 21.1%      | <=5%   | 30.2%                    |
| Preparation for CCR                                   | % Taking Courses    | 84.0%      | 75%    | 80.6%                    |
|                                                       | % Passing Exams     | N/A        | 75%    | 36.0%                    |
| On-track to High School Graduation                    |                     | 74.1%      | 94%    | 84.5%                    |
| 4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)          |                     | .          | 94%    | 88.8%                    |
| 6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort) |                     | .          | 94%    | 85.2%                    |
| Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)                |                     | .          | 75%    | 67.4%                    |
| Arts Access                                           |                     | 43.5%      | 60%    | 50.7%                    |

*NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.*

| Gap Indicators      | Non-High Needs Rate <sup>1</sup> | High Needs Rate | Size of Gap | State Gap Mean +1 Stdev <sup>2</sup> | Is Gap an Outlier? <sup>2</sup> |
|---------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------|-------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Graduation Rate Gap | .                                | .               | .           | .                                    | .                               |

<sup>1</sup> If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

<sup>2</sup> If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

*NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.*

### Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

*NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>*

#### Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at [http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ\\_revisedDec2018.pdf](http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf)

Detailed Presentation at [https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System\\_Detailed%20Presentation\\_Jan\\_2020.pdf](https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf)

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at [https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using\\_Accountability\\_Results\\_to\\_Guide\\_Improvement.pdf](https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf)

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### Narratives

#### School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Norwich Public Schools (NPS) is home to seven elementary schools, two middle schools, two preschools, and two family resource centers. During the 2020-2021 school year, the district continued several district improvement efforts including improvement of academic programs, special education programs, truancy prevention, and parental outreach efforts. Improving Academic Programs: During the 2020-2021 school year, continued collaboration and consultation between Norwich Public Schools, Non-Public school staff, and families of those students enrolled in local Non-Public Schools who required special education services and provided programming and materials as necessary. Improved the academic achievement of special education students in the area of literacy development by improved literacy instructional opportunities provided by general education teachers, special educators, and paraeducators. The district invested in reading specialists to provide explicit instruction utilizing research-based interventions in reading. In addition, Academic Reading Specialists continued to provide direct instruction and monitor student progress using research-based interventions in reading. The district is invested in better supports and streamlined practices for English Language Learners. Our TESOL's delivered lessons in core classes as well as small groups that allowed ELL learners to acquire academic knowledge. ELL coaching occurred focusing on collaboration and co-teaching to support in implementing SIOP strategies across Tier 1 instruction. In addition, the district focused on strengthening the comprehensive core classroom (Tier 1) mathematics instructional program by providing training for administrators and teachers in the implementation of core curriculum and professional development through Engage NY- Eureka. Many efforts were made to ensure that students continued to attend school throughout the distance learning. Processes were put into place which started with a communication campaign from the classroom teachers, to wellness checks if contact was not established with the student or family. As a district, about 15% of the student population participated in remote learning. Throughout the year during the switch to hybrid, remote learning, and in-person learning, the district held monthly district-level and bi-weekly school-based attendance team meetings which included representatives from each school. These meetings included a review of bi-weekly chronic absenteeism data as a review of the effectiveness of tier I and II attendance interventions and facilitated building-wide attendance campaigns, incentives, small group interventions, and individual outreach to students and families inclusive of home visits, connections to local agencies as needed, and individual goal setting. Services were provided that families viewed as beneficial and relevant such as services ESL, GED, HS Diploma, technology supports, and other educational supports for adults, and language transition services. Regularly scheduled notices, memos, phone calls, newsletters, and other communications (Class Dojo, Messenger, and Kinvo) were sent home. Home visits at transition points were facilitated with parents. Established parenting-help sessions were facilitated to support students at home. Information on community activities that link to learning skills was provided.

#### Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Norwich Public Schools is home to two intra-district magnet elementary schools: one which focuses on environmental education and the other focuses on technology and the arts. In conjunction with the elementary offerings, our two magnet middle schools provide opportunities for students in the areas of STEAM and Global Studies. Student recruitment efforts at all magnet schools are intended to reduce racial, ethnic, and socioeconomic isolation. Within the community of Norwich, parents have school choices for their children. Besides the four intra- district magnet schools, parents can opt to send their child to magnet schools in the city of New London or to one of the LEARN-sponsored magnet schools in the region. In conjunction with the magnet school offerings, a high leverage Equity Policy was approved by the Norwich BOE. The purpose of this policy is to establish a framework for racial equity for Norwich Public School students, to ensure the elimination of racial bias, particularly institutional racism, and any prejudice or unlawful discrimination that may affect student achievement and learning experiences, and to promote learning and working environments that welcome, respect, and value equity and diversity. An equity plan was also developed to eliminate barriers to achieving race equity, and support opportunities and bridges to race equity success. Norwich Public Schools established an agreement to participate in The Connecticut Teacher Residency Program as an alternate route to elementary certification program focused on increasing educators of color in elementary schools. In addition, Norwich Public Schools attended virtual recruitment fairs such as the RESC Alliance Recruitment Fair and the Association of Latino Administrators and Superintendents (ALAS) Job Fair. Norwich Public Schools developed a short-range, middle-range, and long-range plan for educator recruitment for diversifying the workforce. In addition, the district has a focus on retention and has included intermittent surveys and interviews regarding hiring practices and climate administered at specific intervals.

# District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

## Norwich School District

### **Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools**

The district ensures instructional supply budgets are distributed on a per-pupil basis. Student needs are met through a variety of state, federal, and local funding sources to enhance the general fund offerings. Norwich Public Schools relies heavily on state and federal grants to support initiatives and District Improvement Goals. The additional funding sources often require an analysis of student need including free reduced lunch status, or the number of English learners and/or special education students. School enrollment and student need are both considered to ensure an equitable distribution of funds.